EXT. PARKING LOT ROOF - EVENING

ALICE (20) and DUNCAN (22) sit on a random parking lot roof top. Sitting along the ledge, looking out at the city lights and cars below.

Alice is smoking a cigarette, huffing and coughing.

Duncan takes a deep breath.

DUNCAN
I hate this.

She blows out smoke as she traces the sidewalks with her eyes.

ALICE
Hate what? The view or the smoking?

Duncan looks out at the beautiful view letting the silence speak for him.

Alice flicks the ash off her cigarette, watching his expression.

ALICE (cont'd)
Well.. the view isn't half bad.. but you look like you're in pain.

Duncan avoids eye contact.

DUNCAN
You look fine.

She smirks slightly, taking another drag.

ALICE
Flattery won't distract me from that face.

Duncan looks over her head.

DUNCAN
Is the face not doing it for you?

She raises an eyebrow, grabbing his chin to make him face her.

ALICE
Don't be cute. What's wrong with you?

Duncan seems to wince slightly. His eyes start to plead.

DUNCAN
Put it out... please.

She sighs and stubs the cigarette on the concrete, still holding his chin firmly.

ALICE
There. Happy now?

DUNCAN
(Stifling)
Thank you.

Alice pulls his chin to match her height.

ALICE
Seriously. Tell me. Now.

DUNCAN
You need to get your shit together.

She lets go of his chin.

ALICE
(scoffing)
I’m fine.
You’re the one acting weird.

Duncan looks away, he runs his eyes along the skyline.

Alice leans forward to look at him better.

A single tear rolls down Duncan’s cheek.

Alice sighs.

ALICE (cont’d)
Alright... fuck. Don’t cry.

DUNCAN
I hate when you smoke and get like this.

Alice crosses her arms.

ALICE
Like what? Drunk? High? You know I can’t help it.

Duncan keeps his eyes away.

Alice throws her head back.

ALICE (cont'd)
You're judging me again.

DUNCAN
Again?

She looks down as her feet swing off the edge.

ALICE
You always judge me. Always have.

DUNCAN
(sarcastic)
Yeah... I'm the problem.

Her head snaps up to meet his eyes.

ALICE
(irritated)
Don't twist this. You're the problem for being so perfect and expecting me to be perfect too.

DUNCAN
Perfect?

ALICE
Yeah, perfect. Straight A student, super nice, supportive of my art. Meanwhile, I'm just... this.

Alice gestures to herself messily.

DUNCAN
Oh please, save the pity party!

She glares at him.

ALICE
It's not a pity party! It's the truth. You have everything going for you and I have nothing but my vices.

DUNCAN
Yeah sure, like you aren't great. I love you! Are you saying I don't know how to pick em?

Her glare softens. Still defensive.

ALICE
You love me, but you hate what I do. You say you accept it, but you don't. You flinch when I cough from smoking.

DUNCAN
And that’s a bad thing?

She throws her hands up in frustration.

ALICE
It is when you look at me like I’m diseased! Like I’m disappointing you every time I light up.

DUNCAN
Well you kinda fucking are!

ALICE
I can’t change who I am! I can’t just stop because you’re uncomfortable!

DUNCAN
I would.

ALICE
You would what? Stop being yourself?

DUNCAN
The smoking isn’t you.

ALICE
It’s part of me now. I’ve been doing it for years. It’s not just something I can “put down”.

Duncan sighs and taking in the view again.

ALICE (cont’d)
You want me to quit, but you know I won’t. We’ve had this fight a thousand times.

DUNCAN
When will it be the last?

Her voice trembles.

ALICE
Maybe when I finally die from it. Or when you leave me because of it.

DUNCAN
Oh? You have all the answers?!

ALICE
I do not have all the answers! I’m just fucking realistic! You deserve better than this toxic relationship!

DUNCAN
NO! You deserve better then these!

Duncan grabs the cigarettes and throws them off the roof.

She gasps, reaching for them angrily.

ALICE
Hey! Those were my last pack!

She grabs his arm roughly.

ALICE (cont'd)
You're such a controlling prick!

DUNCAN
You need help!

She shoves him slightly, tears falling.

ALICE
I don't need help! I need my damn cigarettes.

Duncan starts to fall from the edge.

She lunges to catch the back of his jeans and pull him back from the belt buckle sitting him on the edge more.

ALICE (cont'd)
Duncan!

He gets off the edge out of fear and starts to pace.

ALICE (cont'd)
You fucking idiot! You almost killed yourself by throw my stuff off the roof! We're even.

Duncan is beating heavily, he stops pacing and faces her.

DUNCAN
Even?! That is not how that works!

She gets off the edge and start to walk to the stairs.

ALICE
Whatever. I'm going home. Stay here and sulk.

She gets almost all the way through the door.

DUNCAN (O.S.)
Hey Dumbass!

She stops and whips around.

ALICE
What now?

Duncan holds up car keys.

DUNCAN
I drove.

Alice rolls her eyes.

ALICE
Fine then drive me, but no talking.

Alice walks through the door.

The door clicks closed.